

Aesop's Digital Marketing Campaign

1. Campaign Objective

Building on the previous situational and audience analysis, this report develops a digital marketing strategy for Aesop in the UK market, focusing on female consumers aged 25-34 earning approximately £30,000 to £40,000 per year, who value product quality, ingredients, brand image and social responsibility.

The campaign primarily focuses on increasing awareness and audience engagement while strengthening the consideration stage, guiding consumers towards more informed and confident purchase decisions.

It aims to make the audience feel more confident and reassured in their skincare choices, particularly in a market where products are often heavily promoted or exaggerated (Marsh, 2024). It also aims to shape the perception that Aesop offers reliable and high-quality products that justify its premium positioning. Ultimately, the campaign encourages consumers to engage with the brand, explore product information and make considered purchase decisions rather than impulsive ones.

Rather than focusing on short-term sales, this campaign supports long-term brand positioning by using non-aggressive and value-driven communication that aligns with both Aesop's identity and the expectations of its target audience.

Therefore, the report will first introduce three digital marketing tools – social media marketing, influencer marketing and email marketing, including how they will be applied in

practice, the role in the overall strategy, their advantages and disadvantages. It will then examine the ethical considerations and solutions associated with this campaign.

2. Digital Marketing Tools & Strategies

2.1 Social Media Marketing

2.1.1 Practical Use

A series of three minimalist-style image-only posts, consistent with Aesop's existing visual identity, will be published on Instagram during May to align with seasonal skincare changes.

The first post will focus on information sharing, introducing different skin conditions and helping consumers identify their own skin type. It will also include a link to book a free in-store skin consultation.

The second post will present selected Aesop products, recommending different options based on skin types during seasonal transition.

The third post is an add-on to the first post, encouraging user participation through a campaign hashtag such as *#AesopSkinCheck*, where consumers share their consultation experience. As an incentive, users who book a consultation can receive a 20% discount on facial treatment services, as shown in *Figure 1*.

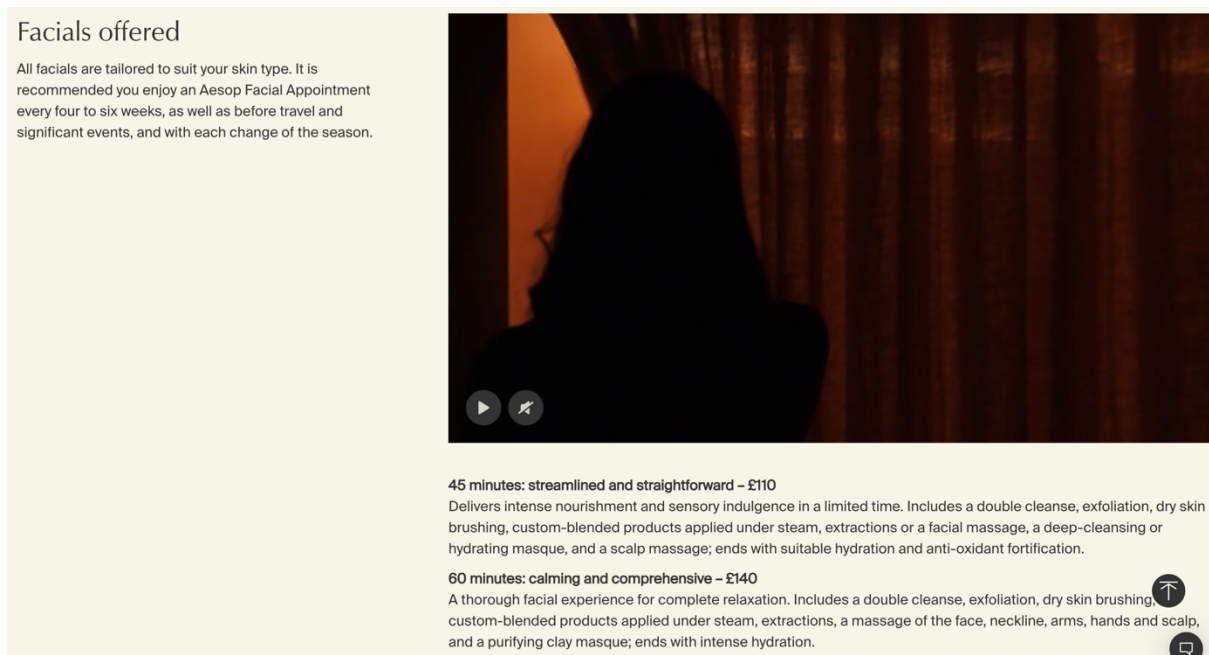


Figure 1: Facial Appointments on Aesop's website (Aesop, 2025)

2.1.2 Justification and Benefits

Instagram is selected as the primary platform as this campaign is image-based, making it more suitable than TikTok, which focuses more on video content. In addition, as shown in *Figure 2*, 33.3% of Instagram users in the UK fall within the 25-34 age group, representing the largest user segment. This aligns closely with Aesop's target audience, making Instagram a more effective platform for this campaign.

In terms of the posts, the first two posts focus on providing information on how skin condition can be affected by seasonal change, instead of aggressive promotion. Educating consumers helps them better understand themselves and recognise their needs, as well as how specific products can benefit them (Burton, 2002). This approach can build consumer trust in the brand (Eisingerich and Bell, 2008), as the content presents information rather than pushing immediate sales, allowing consumers to make their own decisions.

In addition, as suggested by Ehrlich and Fisher (1982), marketing can uncover existing but unrecognised needs rather than creating entirely new ones. By explaining how seasonal changes affect the skin, the campaign helps consumers become aware of issues they may not have previously considered. This naturally encourages demand without forcing purchase behaviour.

This approach also aligns with Aesop's brand identity as a knowledge-driven and non-commercial brand, reducing the risk of audience resistance. Compared to heavily promotional skincare content on social media, this strategy feels more credible and less intrusive (Board, 2024).

Furthermore, the final post introduces a free consultation, which encourages offline engagement and connects digital interaction with in-store experience. Research shows that product trial and direct experience can significantly increase purchase intention (Kempf and Smith, 1998). For consumers who may not have previously used Aesop products, this consultation lowers the barrier to entry and allows them to experience the product in a low-risk setting.

The incentive to share their experience using a campaign hashtag also increases engagement and encourages user-generated content. Such peer-generated content is often perceived as more authentic and trustworthy (Goh, Heng and Lin, 2018), which can further influence other consumers' decisions, consistent with the growing reliance on peer reviews identified in the previous report.

Overall, this approach plays a key role in the overall strategy by building initial awareness, encouraging engagement and generating authentic peer reviews. At the same time, it

maintains Aesop's premium brand image by delivering content that feels informative, credible and non-promotional, helping consumers develop a sense of trust towards the brand.

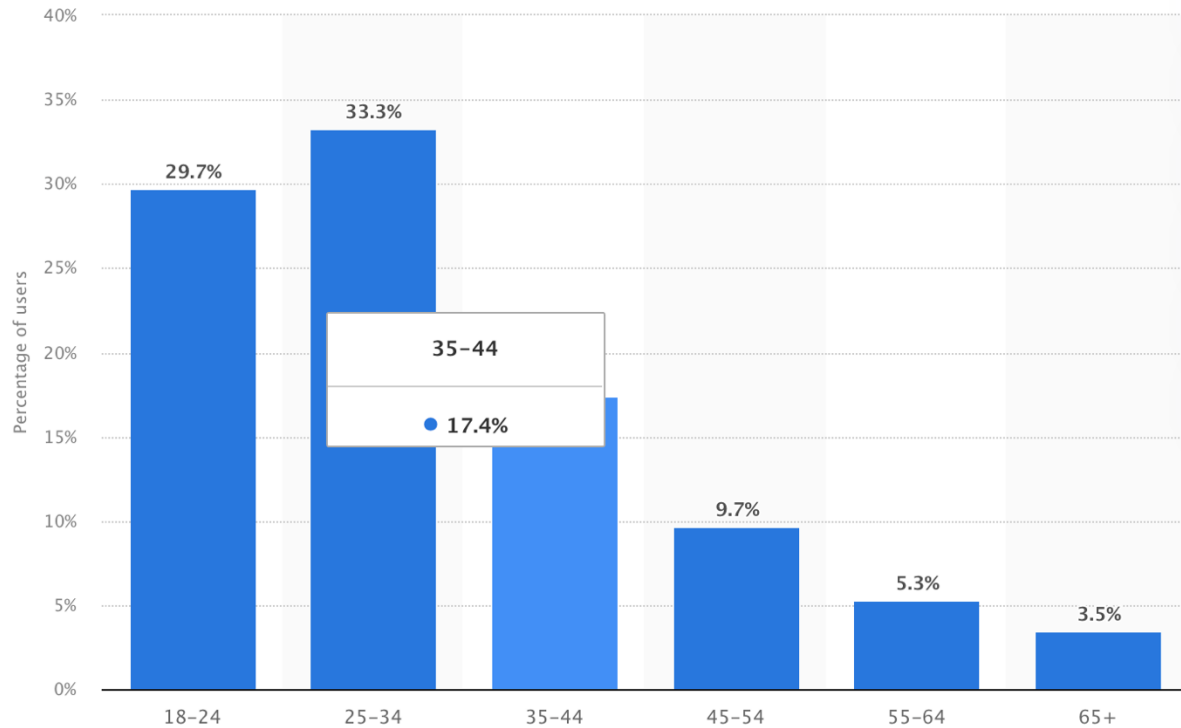


Figure 2: Instagram User Distribution by Age (Statista, 2025)

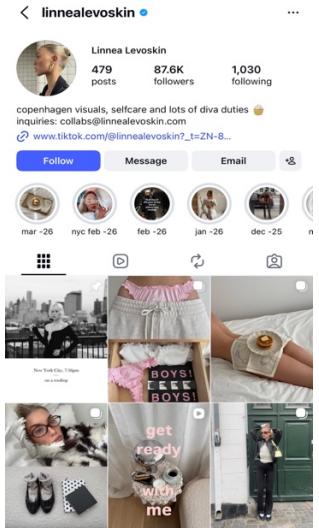
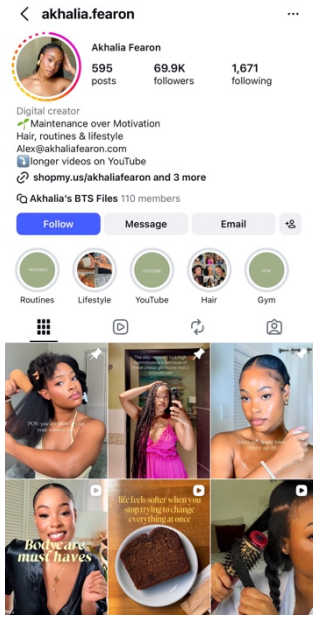
2.1.3 Limitation

The effectiveness of this campaign depends on active user participation, such as booking consultations or sharing experiences online. However, participation requires time and effort, which may discourage some users and limit overall campaign impact.

There is also a risk that the educational content may not capture attention quickly in a highly competitive social media environment, where users are often exposed to fast-paced and visually stimulating content (Hudders, 2025).

2.2 Influencer Marketing

2.2.1 Practical Use

Influencers	Introduction	Link to Instagram	Profile
Linnea Levoskin	A lifestyle and skincare content creator focusing on simple routines, natural aesthetics and mindful self-care. Her content often highlights minimal skincare practices and calm, slow-paced living.	https://www.instagram.com/linnealevoskin?igsh=MThyZnJ3eTB6NWI1eQ==	 Instagram profile of Linnea Levoskin. The profile shows 479 posts, 87.6K followers, and 1,030 following. The bio mentions 'copenhagen visuals, selfcare and lots of diva duties' and includes a website link. The grid features various lifestyle and skincare images.
Akhalia Fearon	A wellness and lifestyle creator who shares content around daily routines and hair style. Her content emphasises authenticity and a balanced approach to beauty and lifestyle.	https://www.instagram.com/akhalia.fearon?igsh=eXdtZXIxcM00OXo4	 Instagram profile of Akhalia Fearon. The profile shows 595 posts, 69.9K followers, and 1,671 following. The bio identifies her as a 'Digital creator' focused on 'Maintenance over Motivation' and 'Hair, routines & lifestyle'. It also lists her email and a YouTube channel. The grid features images related to her content, including hair and lifestyle.

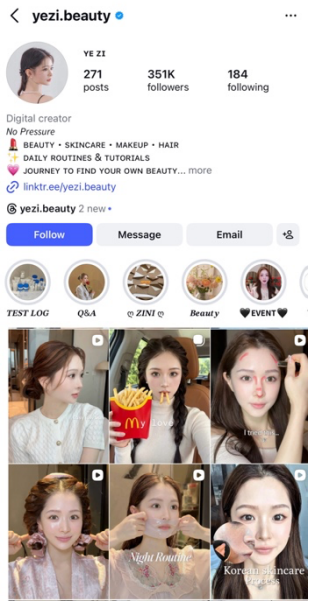
Yezi. Beauty	A skincare-focused creator who shares product reviews, routines and skincare knowledge, with a strong focus on ingredient awareness and everyday skin concerns.	https://www.instagram.com/yezi.beauty?igsh=ZGRsb3EyMzQwZzJ0	
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Table 1: Summary of Selected Influencers

Examples of selected influencers are summarised in *Table 1* above. These creators will produce content primarily on Instagram, aligning with the platform used in the social media strategy.

Instead of direct promotion, influencers will create soft, experience-based content, such as daily skincare routines where Aesop products are naturally integrated. This avoids overly commercial messaging while still increasing product visibility.

In addition, influencers will document their experience of Aesop’s in-store skin consultation and facial treatments through vlogs or posts. This links directly to the social media campaign and encourages audiences to engage with the offline experience.

2.2.2 Justification and Benefits

Influencer activity will primarily take place on Instagram, as the platform aligns with Aesop's visual and aesthetic brand identity. Influencers are selected as they fall within the 25-34 age group, which is more relatable and relevant to the target audience.

Influencers should be carefully selected to match brand's positioning (Leung, Gu and Palmatier, 2022). As this campaign aims to reinforce a premium image and long-term skincare solution, creators are chosen based on a minimalistic style, calm tone and alignment with values such as sustainability and mindful consumption.

Rather than focusing on beauty influencers alone, this strategy includes lifestyle and wellness creators who share content related to daily routines, self-care and personal wellbeing. This reflects the target audience's broader interests (as analysed in the previous report) beyond skincare and helps position Aesop within a wider lifestyle context.

In addition, the selected influencers represent diverse racial backgrounds. This helps avoid a narrow or exclusive brand perception and reinforces Aesop's positioning as a brand suitable for different skin types and individuals. Therefore, this influencer marketing is a tool for increasing visibility and building long-term relationships rather than driving immediate sales.

2.2.3 Limitation

Influencer-generated content is less controllable, which may lead to inconsistencies in messaging or presentation. There is also a risk that audiences may question authenticity if collaborations are perceived as overly commercial (Audrezet, de Kerviler and Guidry Moulard, 2020)

2.3 Email Marketing

2.3.1 Practical Use

Email marketing in this campaign is used as a complement to social media marketing, supporting the later stages of the customer journey. Emails will be sent after a consumer books a consultation, creating a continuous and personalised experience.

Firstly, a confirmation email will be sent after booking, including appointment details as well as a brief introduction to what the consumer can expect from the consultation. This helps consumers reduce uncertainty and prepares them for the in-store experience.

After the consultation or facial appointment, a follow-up email will be sent to remind consumers of their experience. Aesop can achieve this by using AI-supported tools (CRM systems such as Salesforce or HubSpot) to generate personalised emails. This may include tailored product suggestions, skincare advice, and a summary of what was discussed or what products were used during the consultation. This helps maintain brand visibility and supports consumers in making more informed purchase decisions after trying the products.

Additionally, email can be used to introduce a softer form of recommendation, such as “recommended routine based on your consultation”, rather than direct promotion. This keeps the communication aligned with Aesop’s non-aggressive and knowledge-driven brand identity.

2.3.2 Justifications and Benefits

This approach supports the overall strategy by strengthening the conversion stage after consumers have booked a consultation or facial appointment. While social media and influencer marketing focus on awareness and trust, this email marketing helps guide consumers towards final purchase decisions.

Email marketing enables the brand to build a closer relationship with consumers through personalised communication. Research shows that consumers respond positively to personalised marketing (Franke, Keinz and Steger, 2009). By sending tailored emails that include the customer's name, consultation feedback and personalised skincare recommendations, consumers are more likely to feel valued and involved with Aesop. Therefore, it can increase customer satisfaction and strengthen trust, which may lead to a higher likelihood of purchase after the consultation.

In addition, the use of AI tools in email marketing can improve efficiency by automating communication (Kumar, Ashraf and Nadeem, 2024). Research shows that using AI email marketing tools can bring 30% increase in operational time and 25% reduction in costs (Brach, 2024). Furthermore, email marketing allows the brand to track consumer engagement, such as open rates and click-through rates (Nobile and Cantoni, 2023), which can provide useful data to evaluate campaign performance and optimise future communication strategies.

2.3.3 Limitation

However, some research suggests that personalised email marketing may have negative effects, as consumers may have concerns about their personal data and privacy (Hayes et al., 2021). Some consumers are reluctant to receive emails from brands, as they may consider them unnecessary (Feeley, 2023). This can lead to low open rates and limited effectiveness and may negatively affect the overall brand experience.

3. Ethical Considerations and Mitigation

Firstly, the risk of misleading or exaggerated skincare claims should be avoided. Such content is common on social media, especially for beauty and medical products, which create unrealistic expectations about product effectiveness (Marsh, 2024). To avoid this, the campaign focuses on educational and experience-based content rather than promotional messaging. Influencers are selected based on their authentic and non-commercial style, and no before-and-after comparisons will be used. This can reduce the risk of misleading consumers and reinforces the idea that skincare is a long-term process.

Secondly, transparency in influencer marketing needs to be carefully considered. If sponsored content is not clearly disclosed, it may reduce consumer trust (Stubb and Colliander, 2019) and could be penalised for misleading consumers (Advertising Standards Authority | Committee of Advertising Practice, 2026). Therefore, all influencer collaborations in this campaign will clearly indicate when content is sponsored, ensuring that audiences are aware of the commercial relationship.

Lastly, the use of personalised email marketing raises concerns about data privacy. Consumers may feel uncomfortable if their personal data is used without clear consent (Hayes et al., 2021). To address this, the campaign will follow data protection regulations such as GDPR, ensuring that users opt in to receive emails and can unsubscribe at any time.

4. Conclusion

Overall, this report has outlined the campaign objective of increasing Aesop's visibility, improving conversion, and encouraging stronger engagement with the brand. It has also examined the use of three digital marketing tools – social media, influencer marketing and email marketing – along with their practical application, advantages and limitations. Finally, it has discussed the potential ethical issues associated with the campaign and how these can

be addressed. These strategies help minimise ethical risks while maintaining Aesop's credible and responsible brand image.